

What This Step Adds

So far, Kiro reviews based on your project context (steering) and a structured process (skill). Now create a Power that packages MCP tools and workflow guidance into a bundle that Kiro activates automatically when it sees Terraform-related keywords. Powers solve the context problem: instead of loading MCP tools into every conversation, only relevant tools load when needed.

What a Power Exposes

```
Power (~/.power-infra-review/)
├─ POWER.md      -> Exposed via kiroPowers "activate" action
├─ mcp.json      -> MCP tools exposed via kiroPowers "use" action
├─ steering/
│   └─ *.md      -> Exposed via kiroPowers "readSteering" action

NOT exposed: scripts/, references/, assets/
(That's why the Power references the workspace Skill for those)
```

Power + Skill Relationship

	Power	Skill
Provides	MCP tools + auto-activation via keywords	Review workflow + team standards + scripts + templates
Activation	Automatic (keyword match)	On-demand (description match or slash command)
Scope	Standalone package (outside workspace)	Workspace or global (inside .kiro/skills/)

The Skill works without the Power (just no MCP lookups). The Power works without the Skill (just no structured workflow). Together, they're more powerful than either alone.

Build the Power

Step 1: Create the power directory **outside** your workspace (powers are standalone packages):

macOS / Linux

Windows (PowerShell)

```
1  mkdir -p ~/.power-infra-review/steering
```

The power structure:

```
power-infra-review/
├─ POWER.md          # Required: metadata + onboarding
├─ mcp.json          # MCP server config
├─ steering/
│   └─ tf-review-workflow.md # Workflow guidance for MCP tools
```

Step 2: Create the file ~/.power-infra-review/POWER.md (Open **terminal** if not exist and run kiro ~/.power-infra-review/POWER.md in it):

```
1  ---
2  name: "power-infra-review"
3  displayName: "power-infra-review"
4  description: "Review Terraform and infrastructure code for security, compliance, cost, and best practices using Terraform registry tools"
5  keywords: ["terraform", "infrastructure", "iac", "infra", "review", "compliance", "security", "hcl"]
6  ---
7
8  # Onboarding
9
10 ## Step 1: Validate tools
11 Ensure the following are available:
12 - ** Python 3.10+ ** and ** uv **: Required for the Terraform MCP server
13   - Verify with: `uv --version`
14   - If uv is not installed, the MCP tools will not be available.
15
16 ## Step 2: Validate workspace
17 Check that the workspace contains .tf files or infrastructure code to review.
18
19 ## Step 3: Verify project context
20 Confirm that the project's steering file exists at `~/.kiro/steering/project-infra.md`.
21 If missing, recommend creating one with the project's accounts, regions, and naming conventions.
22
23 # Steering Instructions
24
25 ## When to Load Steering Files
26 - Reviewing Terraform files or plan output -> `tf-review-workflow.md`
27
28 ## Skill Integration
29 This power works together with the ** tf-plan-review ** skill from the workspace.
30 Always activate the tf-plan-review skill when performing a review.
31
32 ## MCP Server
33 This power bundles `awslabs.terraform-mcp-server`.
34 Use its tools to look up provider docs, search the registry for modules, and run security scans.
```

Step 3: Create ~/.power-infra-review/mcp.json (Open **terminal** if not exist and run kiro ~/.power-infra-review/mcp.json in it) to bundle the [AWS Terraform MCP Server](#) 🔗:

```
1  {
2    "mcpServers": {
3      "awslabs.terraform-mcp-server": {
4        "command": "uvx",
5        "args": ["awslabs.terraform-mcp-server@latest"],
6        "env": {
7          "FASTMCP_LOG_LEVEL": "ERROR"
8        },
9        "disabled": false,
10       "autoApprove": []
11     }
12   }
13 }
```

Step 4: Create ~/.power-infra-review/steering/tf-review-workflow.md (Open **terminal** if not exist and run kiro ~/.power-infra-review/steering/tf-review-workflow.md in it):

```
1  # MCP Enhancement Guide for Terraform Reviews
2
3  This steering file enhances the tf-plan-review skill with MCP tools.
4  Always follow the tf-plan-review skill as the primary review workflow.
5
6  ## During Resource Analysis
7  Use MCP tools to:
8  - Look up AWS provider docs for each resource type
9  - Verify required attributes are set (e.g., encryption, logging)
10 - Check for deprecated attributes or resources
11
12 ## During Security Review
13 Use MCP tools to:
14 - Run Checkov scans on the Terraform code if available
15 - Map Checkov findings to specific resources and lines
16 - Suggest remediation based on provider docs
17
18 ## During Best Practices Check
19 Use MCP tools to:
20 - Search the Terraform Registry for well-maintained modules
21 - Suggest modules that replace complex inline resource definitions
22 - Check configurations against AWS Well-Architected guidance
23
24 ## Output
25 Use the tf-plan-review skill's output format and templates.
26 Add a "Registry Suggestions" section when recommending modules.
```

Install and Test

Step 5: Install the power locally:

- Open the Command Palette and run "Kiro: Configure Powers"
- Click "Add power from Local Path"
- Navigate to ~/.power-infra-review/ and select it
- Verify the power appears in the Powers panel

Step 6: Test the power in a new chat:

```
use power-infra-review power to review sample-infra.tf
```

Check the context indicator to confirm the power activated.

Step 7: Compare the output with steps 3.1 and 3.2. The power adds:

- Automatic activation:** Kiro loads the power when it detects Terraform keywords
- MCP tools:** real Terraform Registry lookups, AWS provider docs, Checkov scanning
- Skill integration:** the power references the tf-plan-review skill for the structured workflow
- Shareability:** push the power to GitHub and others can install it with one click

⚠️ CLI Note

Powers are an IDE-only feature. In the CLI, you achieve the same result by adding MCP servers directly to the agent's mcpServers configuration (shown in the next step).

🕒 What's Next

The Power works, but you have to mention it explicitly or rely on keyword activation. In the next step, you'll create a dedicated agent that ties all layers together and can be invoked by name.

Ref: [Create Powers](#) 🔗 | [AWS Terraform MCP Server](#) 🔗 | [Powers Marketplace](#) 🔗